

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

Toronto, Canada • +1 (416) 856-1276 • saber.ayatollahi@gmail.com • www.linkedin.com/in/sayatollahi

SUMMARY

Model validation and model risk professional with ~7 years across derivatives analytics, balance-sheet risk, and ALM modelling. At Moody's Analytics, holds delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs for multi-asset institutional portfolios (\$5-25bn per engagement) – independently challenges assumptions, benchmarks, and documentation prior to production release. CFA charterholder with dual MSc (Financial Modelling, Engineering); applied knowledge of OSFI E-23 and SR 11-7 model risk frameworks.

CORE SKILLS

Model Validation & Effective Challenge • Model Risk Management (OSFI E-23, SR 11-7) • Derivatives Valuation Review (Rates, FX, Inflation) • Benchmark & Replication Testing • Assumptions, Inputs & Data Review • Stress Testing & Scenario Analysis • Model Documentation & Governance Reporting • Python (Advanced), SQL (Intermediate) • Stakeholder Engagement & Escalation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director – Modelling Services | Toronto, May 2023 – Present

Independent Validation & Effective Challenge

- Holds delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs delivered to multi-asset institutional client portfolios (\$5-25bn per engagement; ~\$50bn+ cumulative) – independently reviews curve construction, spread calibration, and cross-asset interactions prior to production release.
- Validates derivatives pricing outputs across rates, FX, and inflation; cross-checks sensitivities and scenario impacts at portfolio-level aggregates against developer results to assess replicability and identify discrepancies.
- Provides effective challenge on assumptions, inputs, and economic defensibility – escalates outputs lacking mathematical or economic support to product owners and clients' Heads of Risk; quantifies model limitations and documents conditions for use.

Stress Testing, Benchmarks & Methodology Review

- Reviews interest-rate and duration analytics under parallel and non-parallel rate shocks, benchmarking model outputs against expected behaviour to identify deficiencies and recommend methodology changes.
- Contributed to the design of an enterprise multi-asset cash-flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios – reviewed and validated embedded behavioral assumptions, prepayment logic, and macro stress overlays for analytical defensibility.
- Reviews aggregation logic converting security-level exposures into portfolio-level risk metrics, identifying deficiencies in assumptions and recommending changes to methodology.

Governance, Documentation & Stakeholder Reporting

- Operates within Moody's formal model-governance framework consistent with SR 11-7 and OSFI E-23 expectations – maintains validation documentation, audit trails, and sign-off records suitable for regulatory examination.
- Re-engineered manual spreadsheet workflows into auditable Python analytics pipelines with embedded logging, version control, and validation scaffolding; deployed agentic-AI tooling (Claude Code, Cursor) reducing review cycle time by an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.
- Prepares analytical summaries and challenge memos for senior stakeholders covering model outputs, scenario impacts, and sensitivity results; interfaces directly with clients' Heads of Risk and investment committees.

Client Service Specialist | Toronto, May 2022 – May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms migrating to the PFaroe analytics platform; validated model outputs post-deployment.
- Translated investment-team requirements into Product Owner requests; advised clients on asset, liability, and ALM configurations, contributing to successful migration of all assigned accounts from the legacy Calypso platform.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant – IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation | *Toronto, Sep 2021 – Apr 2022*

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 technology-transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients; contributed to governance documentation and regulatory-readiness processes.
- Advised actuarial, IT, finance, and risk functions on adoption of new standards; coordinated cross-functional teams on milestone delivery and implementation materials.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant – Asset-Liability Management & Risk | *Toronto, Feb 2019 – Sep 2021*

- Built and validated stochastic economic scenario generators assessing interest-rate, inflation, and currency risk under base-case and stressed environments for Canadian and international institutional clients.
- Performed asset-only and asset-liability portfolio optimization based on VaR and CVaR using Ortec's GLASS platform, with risk decomposition and near-optimal frontier analysis to test robustness of recommendations.
- Delivered ALM studies for pension funds – analyzed funding ratios, duration mismatch, LDI trade-offs, and hedging strategies; presented findings to investment committees on-site.
- Led the ALM study for a three-plan university pension merger (new jointly-sponsored plan) – developed and validated the model capturing all Funding Policy dynamics, evaluating duration, currency, inflation, and leverage overlay strategies.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) – CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling – Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) – Western University, 2016